

Approved by the City Council September 12, 2023
Regular City Council Meeting
August 1, 2023

6:30 P.M.

The Young Harris City Council met Tuesday, August 1, 2023, at 6:30 PM for their Regular Monthly Meeting. Present at the meeting were the Mayor: Andrea Gibby; City Attorney: Marvin Harkins; City Clerk: Nicolette Wade; Finance Officer: Ana Hess; City Council Members: Matt Miller, Steve Clark, Terry Ingram and John Kelley; Economic Development Director: Denise McKay; Vice President of Finance and Operations at Young Harris College: Bo Wright; Towns County Herald Staff Writer: Brittany Holbrooks; Towns County Civic Association members: Jim Olson and Gordy Jones. Council Member Donald Keys was absent from the meeting.

Call to Order: Mayor Gibby called the meeting to order at 6:30 PM stating that we do have a quorum. John Kelley was not present at the beginning of the meeting but arrived at 6:40 PM.

Agenda: Mayor Gibby asked for a motion to approve the Agenda. Matt Miller made a motion to approve the Agenda, seconded by Terry Ingram, and approved by Steve Clark, Matt Miller and Terry Ingram. This was prior to the arrival of John Kelley. A copy of the Agenda is attached and incorporated herein by reference.

Approval of Minutes of Regular City Council Meeting – July 11, 2023 – 6:30 PM: Steve Clark made a motion to approve the Minutes of the July 11, 2023 City Council Meeting, seconded by Terry Ingram, and approved by Steve Clark, Matt Miller, and Terry Ingram. This was prior to the arrival of John Kelley. A copy of the Minutes is attached and incorporated herein by reference.

Financial Report- Ana Hess: Ana told the Council that everything is as expected this time of year with no surprises. The percentages are on target. She applied for a grant for equipment. A copy of the June 2023 Financial Report Package is attached and incorporated herein by reference. She also obtained three audit proposals and based on the size, structure of the firm and costs one firm has her approval to go forward.

Attorney Harkins asked the cost what is the cost involved. Ana's answer was about \$14,000 which Attorney Harkins said is well below the costs that requires bids. Mayor Gibby said the Council had already given Ana permission to get the proposals. Steve Clark made a motion to accept Ana's recommendation for an Audit Firm, seconded by Terry Ingram, and approved unanimously.

Ana also explained she is doing a lot of cleanup on the financial information before the new billing system is downloaded. She wants the reports to be fresh with all accounts correct. There are problems with the customer deposit accounts for several years back so she wants those accounts to be correct before the new billing system goes into operation.

Date of September Meeting: Mayor Gibby reminded the Council that due to the Labor Day Holiday the date of the September Council Meeting was changed at the Organizational Meeting in January from September 5 to September 12.

Sewer Line Rehabilitation: Steve Clark said he is waiting on proposals for 2 sewer lines. They are still talking about manholes. Since the manholes have never been done before it will have to be bid out. He does not know how many manholes there are or what type of rehab there will be.

Steve said the SCADA was installed on the two tanks and three pumps and the lift station. It is real easy to follow. We are still waiting on some equipment for the SCADA on the sewer plant.

Timberline Pumps: The engineers have looked at the plan previously discussed. The two pumps that are larger will not fit into the existing pump house. There are two options. One is to have to build a new building where the existing pump is that will be large enough for the new pumps. The second is to use the existing pump and add a new tank at the lower level which will have two sensors that tell the lower pump that the tank above needs to be filled and tell the upper point that I'm empty don't burn me out.

John Kelley asked Dean what the life of a booster pump is and Dean said it depends on the demand. He said that is the weakest link in any water system. Dean explained there is a vertical pump on Raleigh Ridge that has not had problems in 10 years.

John asked Dean how he feels about keeping the old pump. Dean explained he had Byers come in they can retrofit where there are two alternating pumps that will fit in the existing pump house. All they have to do is flip a switch to make the other pump work and they can go the next day and switch out the broken pump.

John Kelley made a motion to give Steve the authority to get some estimates on the second plan, seconded by Terry Ingram, and approved unanimously.

Water/Maintenance Report: Dean Stanley reported the receipt of 196 meters so we have half of the total. In August we should receive another 196 meters and September should be the final shipment. In August we should receive the 8 test meters to make sure they are programmed where no one else can interfere with our meters.

Dean also said he received all the lead and copper sample reports. They have had several leaks and they are marking meters with a flag and paint getting ready for switch out when the contractors come.

Mayor's Report: Mayor Gibby said we received the Wastewater Plant permit that is pretty much like the previous permit. There are a couple more tests Wayne said he would have to do.

Main Street Georgia: Rosemary Royston gave the Council a map that came out of the Placemaking Committee that identifies several businesses. She gave everyone information about Porchfest on Sunday, September 17. She has 6 bands, 6 vendors and food trucks and is still taking applications. A copy of the map and Porchfest information is attached and incorporated herein by reference.

Rosemary also presented an Agreement for the Georgia Mountains Regional Commission to help the City of Young Harris develop a Master Plan for a cost of \$3000. A copy of the Application is attached and incorporated herein by reference. Mayor Gibby can approve the Master Plan and the Council was in agreement with the proposal.

Mayor Gibby said she, Denise and Rosemary are looking into some grants with the National League of Cities.

Economic Development: Denise McKay reported 27 families on the waiting list for the new apartments. The apartments are under Title 42 which means there are tax credits and certain guidelines for a private company to develop them. Mayor Gibby said it is not a done deal yet but if we get it, it will help people find an affordable place to live. She and Mayor Gibby have been working with the school to develop a Youth Leadership Program for third graders.

Attorney's Report: Attorney Harkins has talked to Ron Bell, the surveyor for the property donated to the City by Shirley Miller, and we are waiting on confirmation from GDOT. We are on schedule to close on the property by September.

He spoke with Stephanie McConnell about the road vagaries issues in Towns County. She said the County has similar issues. She said the best thing to do is develop a policy stating which areas the city will maintain. If the owner says the city needs to do more they will have to bring documentation showing why. Attorney Harkins said he will have a draft policy by the next meeting.

Regarding the new Employee Handbook. He has shared some of the handbook with Ana and wants to get Nicolette and Dean to look at it. He is changing some policies. He hopes to have some of it in writing in September.

There was discussion about a complaint from Walker Street and the ordinance that applies to trimming trees that hang over the road. Attorney Harkins said if the trees are hanging over the street the city has a liability. Mayor Gibby said the staff would love to have a policy. Dean said if the city clears the trees on Walker Street it will cost \$3400 but an outside contractor's cost is \$2500. Mayor Gibby asked Dean to bring in some proposals for next month's meeting.

Matt Miller made a motion to go into Closed Session to discuss personnel and real estate issues, seconded by Terry Ingram and approved unanimously. While in Closed Session the Council authorized the Mayor to sign an affidavit stating that the only issues discussed were personnel and real estate. A copy of the affidavit is attached and incorporated herein by reference.

John Kelley made a motion to return to Open Session, seconded by Terry Ingram and approved unanimously. There were no items to discuss in Open Session so John Kelley made a motion to adjourn Open Session, seconded by Matt Miller and approved unanimously.

Date: _____

Andrea C. Gibby, Mayor

Attest: _____

Nicolette Wade, City Clerk

MEDWAY COUNCIL – JOB PROFILE

JOB TITLE	Social Worker
DIRECTORATE	Children & Adults
SERVICE AREA	Children and Young People With Disabilities Teams
RESPONSIBLE TO	Team Manager
GRADE	SWCS2
JOB FAMILY/LEVEL	PSW0254

MAIN PURPOSE OF JOB

To provide a high quality and effective professional casework service, taking responsibility for working and managing a caseload within a framework of appropriate supervision, dependent upon the complexities of these cases and the social worker's experience.

To comply with legislation, statutory guidance and local policies and procedures.

To be competent in all areas of the PCF at Social Worker level and The Knowledge and Skills Statement (KSS) for approved child and family practitioners.

ACCOUNTABILITIES

Manage a caseload within a framework of appropriate reflective supervision, undertaking focused, analytical assessments, prepare SMART plans and reviews that have clear objectives and outcome measures in order to ensure that all vulnerable children and young adults with disabilities receive a service that reflects the Council's commitment to child and adult safeguarding and meaningful transition into young adulthood.

Demonstrate and model good practice that reflects a commitment to relationship and strengths-based practice, working collaboratively with disabled children, young people and their families

Work directly with disabled children and young people to establish their lived experiences and wishes and feelings, using a variety of techniques, as required.

~~Use the Signs of Safety practice model in assessments and interventions with children and their families.~~

~~Maintain accurate and up to date records in line with Data Protection legislation (GDPR) and use Medway Council specific recording systems to promote effective case management.~~

~~Prepare clear, structured and concise reports for meetings, i.e. Child Protection Conferences, strategy meetings, Looked After Children Reviews, Children in Need meetings, and court proceedings as necessary, to the required standard and within the prescribed timescales.~~

~~Keep up to date with research findings, theoretical models and innovative practice within the social work field in order to maintain the highest professional standards.~~

~~Participate in regular reflective supervision with your manager to review casework and critically reflect on, and identify any areas of learning.~~

~~Maintain a record of continuous professional development in accordance with Social Work England's guidance.~~

~~Keep up to date with the Council's organisational policies, government guidance, legislation, research and national trends in order to maintain the highest professional standards.~~

~~Provide duty cover, on a rota basis, to cover on issues arising and supporting the Multi Agency Safeguarding Hub.~~

KEY CORPORATE ACCOUNTABILITIES

~~To work with colleagues to achieve service plan objectives/targets~~

~~To participate in one to one Performance Development Reviews and contribute to the identification of own and team development needs~~

~~To actively promote the Council's Fair Access, Diversity and Inclusion Policy and observe the standard of conduct which prevents discrimination taking place~~

~~To ensure full compliance with the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974, the Council's Health and Safety Policy and all locally agreed safe methods of work~~

~~To fully understand and be aware of the commitment to the duty under Section 17 of the Crime and Disorder Act 1998 to prevent crime and disorder~~

~~At the discretion of the Head of Service, such other activities as may from time to time be agreed consistent with the nature of the job described above~~

ACCOUNTABILITIES TO CHILDREN AND YOUNG PEOPLE

The children and young people of Medway have said the following qualities are really important to them:

- ✓—Be a good listener
- ✓—Be non-judgemental
- ✓—Be consistent and Stable
- ✓—Be contactable
- ✓—Understand me
- ✓—Be honest
- ✓—Be Focused
- ✓—Be realistic
- ✓—Be a good timekeeper
- ✓—Be resourceful in your approach

Be ambitious for young people and promote others to share the same drive.

Champion Children and Young People's views and rights in everything you do.

Ensure Children and Young People's voices are listened to and acted upon.

'Do what you say and say what you do'.

PERSON SPECIFICATION

QUALIFICATIONS	Assessment Method
Qualified Social Worker.	Application
Successful completion of ASYE year	Application
Registration with Social Work England	Application
EXPERIENCE	
Demonstrable experience of working with disabled children, young people and their families	Application
Ability to use 'Signs of Safety' or a willingness to be trained	Application
Demonstrable experience of undertaking direct work with disabled children and young people.	Application / Interview

Demonstrable experience in relationship and strengths-based practice, working collaboratively with disabled children, young people and their families	Application / Interview
Demonstrable experience in child protection and court work.	Application / Interview
KNOWLEDGE	
Ability to use advanced theoretical/practical/procedural/organisational /policy knowledge across a specialist area	Application
Knowledge and experience of working with vulnerable children in a statutory setting.	Application / Interview
Knowledge and experience in the application of relevant legislation, statutory guidance, standards and local policies and procedures.	Application / Interview
Demonstrable knowledge and experience in the application of relevant theoretical frameworks, practice models and research findings	Interview
Ability to demonstrate awareness of legislation relating to General Data Protection Regulations and Freedom of Information	Application

SKILLS	Assessment Method
Demonstrable ability to build sound, productive working relationships with colleagues, partners and other staff.	Interview
Demonstrates assessment skills and analysis of relevant information and develops multi-agency SMART plans to improve outcomes for children and young people using evidence-based practice	Interview
Engages effectively with children and families and has experience of using different tools and methodologies to communicate with children and young people	Interview
Ability to maintain accurate and up to date case records in a timely manner	Interview
Ability to write good quality written reports which are suitable for a variety of professional settings.	Interview

Ability to analyse and interpret varied and complex information, developing strategies and solutions for the medium and long term	Interview
Ability to use well developed communication skills to present complex/sensitive information in an understandable way, to a range of audiences	Interview
Competent in the use of Microsoft Office packages as well as an electronic integrated children's system (eg: MOSAIC or similar)	Application
Ability to practice effectively and competently with an increasing level of autonomy and independence	Interview
Ability to make good quality judgements and sound decisions in situations of increasing complexity, risk, uncertainty and challenge, and be able to effectively explain and justify decisions.	Interview
Ability to evidence use of relationship building and strengths based practice in assessments and interventions with children and their families.	Interview
Ability to carry out tasks which impact on the wellbeing of people, including assessing needs, implementing care/welfare, implementing regulations, providing guidance on internal procedures and interpreting policies and procedures to meet specific circumstances or problems.	Interview
Ability to work under pressure and manage time and workload effectively.	Interview
Ability to work within a court setting and other professional settings.	Interview
Ability to work effectively as part of a team to achieve team and service plan objectives and targets.	Interview
Ability to maintain confidentiality at all times	Interview

OTHER REQUIREMENTS	Assessment Method
Car driver and daily use of a car for business purposes	Application
Commitment to continuous professional development	Interview

Ability to demonstrate a commitment to individual and reflective supervision	Interview
An understanding of Social Work England's professional standards and a commitment to upholding them in your practice.	Application
Enhanced DBS check	

ORGANISATION

(i) ORGANISATION CHART

(ii) DESCRIBE HOW AND BY WHOM THE POST IS MANAGED

The post holder will be line managed by the Team Manager

(iii) DESCRIBE THE LEVEL OF INITIATIVE AND/OR INDEPENDENCE EXPECTED OF THE POST HOLDER

The post holder will work independently within clear guidelines and regularly use initiative to make decisions, referring to more senior officers for advice on policy/resource issues. The post holder will be able to use their initiative to broaden their repertoire of responses.

(iv) DESCRIBE ANY SUPERVISORY/MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

The post holder will have no direct line management responsibility.

(v) JOB CONTEXT – DESCRIBE THE MAIN CONTACTS, BOTH INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL AND THE PURPOSE OF THOSE CONTACTS

The post holder will be required to liaise with all stakeholders both internal and external to the organisation, including working with Police, YOT, Youth Service, Education services, Health, Schools and other professionals both within and outside of the team, young people and their families.

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITIES

None; however the post holder must have the ability to understand cost implications of resource allocation, financial packages and make recommendations to managers about efficient and cost effective use of resources.

WORKING ENVIRONMENT

The post holder will be based in one of Medway Council's establishments.